

Requirements for building Cake Lake Bakery website

Purpose: Requirements for building a website for Cake Lake Bakery, in plain business terms. We're leaving the technical design — how it's built, hosted, and put together — to the development team; this is about what we need it to do for our business and our customers.

1. Background

We currently take all of our orders manually over WhatsApp. We'd like a website where customers can browse our menu and put together their own order, which then gets handed off to our WhatsApp so we can confirm it and take payment the same way we do today. We want to keep the part of our process that already works — a real conversation with the customer — while cutting out the manual work of writing up every order by hand.

2. What We Want

- A website where customers can browse our menu and build an order themselves, any time, without having to call or message us first.
- Less staff time spent writing up orders manually.
- No change to how we take payment — we don't want online payment processing. Customers should keep paying at the store or on delivery, same as now.
- Customization conversations (special messages, photos to print on a cake, that kind of thing) should keep happening on WhatsApp, where it already works well for us — we don't need a separate feature for that on the website itself.

3. What the Website Needs to Do

3.1 Show Our Menu

Customers should be able to see our full range of cakes and other items, with photos, descriptions, and prices.

3.2 Let Customers Build an Order

Customers should be able to pick items, choose whatever options apply (size, flavour, etc.), and add them to a cart before ordering.

3.3 Send the Order to Our WhatsApp

When a customer is ready to order, the website should put together a clear summary of what they've chosen and hand it off to our WhatsApp number as a ready-to-send message. The customer sends it themselves, which starts (or continues) a WhatsApp conversation with us.

3.4 Let Customers Keep Talking to Us About Customization

Since the order gets confirmed over WhatsApp, customers should be able to carry on that same conversation for anything custom — messages, photos, special requests — exactly like they do today. We don't need this built as a separate website feature.

3.5 Payment

We don't want any payment taken on the website. Customers should keep paying at the store or on delivery, arranged with us over WhatsApp like now.

3.6 Let Customers Download Our Menu

Customers should be able to download a copy of our full menu (a PDF is fine) straight from the website.

3.7 Show Our Contact Details

The website should display how to reach us — phone/WhatsApp number, location, and opening hours.

3.8 Work Well on Phones

Most of our customers will use this on their phone, so it needs to work properly there — not just be a desktop site that happens to also load on mobile.

3.9 Feel Like an App on a Customer's Phone

We asked about a mobile app, and we understand that a full app-store app (iOS/Android) isn't something we need to pay for right now. Instead, we'd like the website itself to be installable — a customer can add it to their home screen and open it like an app, with its own icon, rather than having to search for us in a browser every time. If down the line we decide it's worth listing on the App Store or Google Play, we understand that would be a separate, later addition with its own cost.

4. What We Don't Want in This Phase

To keep costs down and get this launched quickly, we don't want the following included right now. We're open to revisiting these later if we need them:

- Online payment of any kind (cards, Apple Pay, Google Pay, or anything else)
- Customer accounts, logins, or order history
- Live order status tracking on the website

- A dashboard for us to manage orders or update the menu ourselves — for now we're fine sending menu/price changes to you as requests
- Anything that sends the order to WhatsApp automatically without the customer sending it themselves
- A full native app-store app (iOS/Android) — we're happy with the installable, app-like website described above for now

5. Things We Still Need to Decide

We know we haven't nailed these down yet, and we'll get you answers before this is finalized:

- **Delivery vs. pickup only:** whether the website should handle delivery orders at launch, or start with pickup only.
- **Promotions/offers:** whether we want to advertise any time-limited offers or discounts on the website at launch.
- **Menu content:** the final list of items, categories, prices, photos, and any allergen/dietary info we want published.

6. What We'll Provide You

- Our final menu content — item names, descriptions, prices, and photos
- A menu PDF (or the raw content so you can build one)
- The WhatsApp number orders should be sent to
- Our business contact details and opening hours

7. Next Steps

We'd like your team to review this and come back to us with a proposal — including anything here you think needs clarifying, and any questions you have before you start.